

APAC Credit Roundup

US-China relations, Far East Horizon, UOB

- US-China relations – Trump/Xi meeting preview
- Far East Horizon – S&P returns outlook to stable
- UOB – Stable quarter supports the credit

US-China relations – Trump/Xi meeting preview

J.P. Morgan's China Economic research team has published a [preview](#) of the upcoming Trump/Xi meeting. U.S. President Trump will travel to Beijing for a state visit with Chinese President Xi on May 14-15, and the team expects bilateral negotiations to focus on three major areas: **(1) Geopolitics (Iran/Taiwan):** The US is likely to press China to help persuade Iran to reopen the Strait of Hormuz and support broader Middle East de-escalation, while China may seek clearer US language on Taiwan (potentially including a pause or reduction in US arms sales) as part of any strategic accommodation. **(2) Competition in critical minerals and high-tech products:** One focus area is whether the Trump administration further relaxes US export controls on advanced semiconductors in exchange for China easing rare earth restrictions. That said, it is worth noting that China's reliance on US chips appears to be declining as firms increasingly use domestic alternatives. This is evidenced by the recent launch of DeepSeek V4, which uses Huawei Ascend chips instead of Nvidia H200. **(3) Trade:** The team expects US/China to reach an agreement on the framework for continued negotiations, but a comprehensive trade deal looks less likely. China may commit to sizeable purchases of US agricultural goods (e.g., soybeans), as well as Boeing aircraft, crude and natural gas, in order to maintain the tariff status quo. Looking ahead, the team believes trade uncertainty may rise if post-summit trade negotiations drag on, and the US mid-term elections draw closer later this year. Please see the team's report for more details. (*Alvin*)

Far East Horizon – S&P returns outlook to stable

S&P removed Far East Horizon (bond ticker: FRESHK) from CreditWatch negative, affirmed its BBB- ratings, and assigned a Stable outlook. The decision reflects S&P's view that risks to FRESHK's funding profile from its operating lease subsidiary, Horizon Construction Development (HCD; 41.7% owned by FRESHK), are limited, given their reduced financing and operational linkages and highly separate operations, which should strengthen FRESHK's capital position. S&P expects FRESHK to continue outperforming peers in China and believes the resilience in its core financial leasing business could offset HCD's earnings pressure over the next two years, despite headwinds from intensified competition and low interest rates. The Stable outlook also reflects the rating agency's expectations that FRESHK will maintain adequate capital and liquidity and solid asset quality over the next two years. Notably, S&P believes the risk-adjusted

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For key risks and catalysts not already described in this report, please refer to the most recent [Emerging Markets Corporate Coverage Report](#).

See page 4 for analyst certification and important disclosures.

capital (RAC) ratio can remain above 7% even under a full write-off of FRESHK's equity stake in HCD. Downside risk would arise from a material weakening in its competitive position, reflected in sustained profitability deterioration, potentially driven by a weakening franchise or rising asset losses from a more aggressive risk appetite or looser risk management. An upgrade is unlikely in the near term but could follow a sustained RAC ratio above 10%, alongside resilient profitability and better asset quality than peers. We have a Neutral recommendation on the 5.25% 2029 senior bonds, which are offered at z+173bp (SOT2+158bp, \$99.4, 5.5%). (Matt / Emma)

UOB – Stable quarter supports the credit

First-quarter fundamental trends were broadly stable for United Overseas Bank (bond ticker: UOBSP). ROE was flattish sequentially at 11.5% while asset quality and capital metrics remain supportive of the issuer's low double-AA ratings. Last week, we [initiated](#) with an Underweight recommendation on the AUD-denominated five-year bond DBSSP 5.065% '31, offered at ASW+60bp (\$99, YTW 5.3%), issued by DBS, another Singapore lender. We find valuations much less stretched in the UOBSP 5.023% 2031 senior bond, which at ASW +64bp (\$98.7, 5.3%) offers several bps of additional spread and trades in line with Australia's major banks, a level we think is closer to fair. We therefore initiate with a Neutral recommendation. We are seeing increased participation in the AUD market by Asia-based investors, and given their familiarity with Singapore's lenders, greater comfort vis-à-vis Australian majors could result in outperformance, posing an upside risk to our recommendation. On the other hand, if Singapore in general proves more resilient to the current energy shock, the bonds could outperform highly rated comparables such as the Australian majors.

Return on equity was broadly stable at 11.5% in 1Q26, against 11.6% in 4Q25, with net profit rising 2% q/q to \$1.4 billion. Pre-tax earnings increased 2% q/q, reflecting resilient income streams across retail, wholesale, and global markets segments. Net interest income moderated 1% q/q to \$2.3 billion, supported by a 2% q/q growth in average interest earning assets. Net interest margin narrowed by 2bp q/q to 1.82% amid a low interest environment, partly offset by disciplined funding cost management. Net fee income grew 2% q/q to S\$637 million, driven by higher capital market activities and sustained momentum in the wealth business, while other non-interest income surged 45% q/q to S\$462 million, benefiting from stronger customer treasury flows, prudent liquidity management, and gains from trading activities. Customer loans were essentially flat q/q at \$353.8 billion, with loans generated in Singapore and ASEAN accounting for 49.7% and 21.8%, respectively. Provision expenses for credit and other losses increased to \$203 million from \$113 million in the prior quarter, mainly due to lower write-back of general allowance, leading to a total credit costs of 26bp, against 19bp in 4Q25. Asset quality remained stable, with the non-performing loan ratio unchanged at 1.5% q/q, while the non-performing assets coverage ratio improved by 3% pts q/q to 100%. Common Equity Tier 1 ratio strengthened by 0.2% pts q/q to 15.3%, and the total capital ratio increased by 0.2% pts to 17.9%. Management highlighted a full-year net interest margin guidance of 1.75-1.80% and total credit costs of 25-30bp. (Matt / Emma)

Table 1: J.P. Morgan Asia Credit Index Performance

As at 7 May 2026

Index	Return, %				SOT to Worst, bp					YTW, bp & %					Dur.	Mkt Cap (US\$bn)	% of Index
	1D	1W	1M	YTD	1D	1W	1M	YTD	Cur	1D	1W	1M	YTD	Cur	Cur		
JACI	0.2%	0.6%	1.1%	0.9%	-1	-4	-15	-1	85	-3	-10	-14	20	5.2%	4.5	891	100%
JACI IG	0.2%	0.5%	1.0%	0.6%	-1	-3	-11	0	63	-3	-9	-10	21	5.0%	4.8	776	87%
JACI HY	0.2%	0.8%	2.2%	2.7%	-2	-13	-54	-24	318	-4	-18	-54	2	7.3%	2.8	116	13%
JACI APAC	0.2%	0.5%	1.0%	0.8%	-1	-3	-10	-2	112	-4	-9	-11	21	5.2%	5.0	1,469	100%
JACI APAC IG	0.2%	0.5%	0.8%	0.6%	-1	-2	-8	0	86	-4	-9	-8	23	5.0%	5.0	1,307	89%
JACI APAC HY	0.2%	0.6%	2.0%	2.3%	-2	-5	-32	-14	313	-4	-13	-48	4	7.1%	5.2	162	11%
Segmental																	
Sovereign	0.3%	1.0%	1.7%	0.3%	-2	-6	-18	4	73	-4	-12	-18	22	5.2%	6.6	171	19%
Quasi-sov	0.1%	0.5%	0.8%	0.6%	0	-2	-9	0	55	-2	-8	-8	21	4.9%	4.7	202	23%
Financial	0.1%	0.4%	0.8%	1.1%	-2	-4	-13	-8	87	-4	-9	-13	20	4.9%	2.9	246	28%
IG Corp (exfin)	0.1%	0.5%	1.0%	0.8%	0	-3	-11	-3	65	-2	-9	-10	18	5.0%	5.1	205	23%
HY Corp (exfin)	0.2%	0.6%	1.9%	2.7%	2	-3	-45	-21	383	0	-8	-44	5	8.0%	2.8	67	7%
EM comparables																	
CEMBI Broad	0.0%	0.3%	1.6%	1.4%	-2	-5	-31	-9	154	1	-4	-23	17	5.9%	4.3	1,186	100%
IG	0.0%	0.2%	1.1%	0.5%	-2	-4	-22	-7	92	1	-3	-13	18	5.3%	4.9	782	66%
HY	0.0%	0.4%	2.5%	3.3%	-2	-5	-51	-18	326	1	-4	-44	11	7.4%	3.3	405	34%
Asia	0.0%	0.3%	0.9%	1.2%	-2	-6	-22	-10	103	1	-5	-13	18	5.3%	3.7	510	43%
Asia IG	0.0%	0.2%	0.7%	0.9%	-2	-5	-15	-9	67	1	-4	-7	18	5.0%	4.0	414	35%
Asia HY	0.1%	0.5%	1.8%	2.6%	-2	-9	-47	-14	333	1	-7	-38	18	7.5%	2.5	96	8%
LATAM	-0.1%	0.3%	2.2%	2.1%	-1	-4	-37	-21	212	1	-3	-28	3	6.5%	5.1	314	26%
LATAM IG	-0.1%	0.2%	1.4%	-0.4%	-1	-2	-20	-22	116	2	-2	-11	1	5.7%	6.8	132	11%
LATAM HY	0.0%	0.4%	2.8%	4.2%	-3	-6	-53	-35	329	1	-5	-43	-6	7.5%	3.9	182	15%
CEEMEA	0.0%	0.3%	2.1%	1.1%	-3	-4	-38	3	156	0	-3	-32	28	5.9%	4.4	363	31%
CEEMEA IG	0.0%	0.3%	1.7%	0.3%	-3	-4	-31	6	108	0	-3	-24	31	5.5%	5.2	236	20%
CEEMEA HY	0.0%	0.3%	2.7%	2.7%	1	-2	-51	11	316	3	-2	-51	33	7.2%	2.9	127	11%
EMBIG	0.0%	0.8%	2.8%	2.1%	-2	-9	-35	2	181	0	-9	-27	22	6.4%	6.4	1,408	100%
EMBIG IG	0.0%	0.5%	1.7%	0.6%	-3	-5	-24	1	94	0	-5	-15	22	5.5%	7.1	796	57%
EMBIG HY	-0.1%	1.2%	4.4%	4.3%	-2	-16	-58	-1	326	1	-16	-50	20	7.7%	5.5	612	43%
Market breakdown																	
China	0.1%	0.4%	0.6%	0.8%	0	-3	-9	-1	65	-3	-8	-8	22	5.0%	3.7	236	26%
Hong Kong	0.1%	0.5%	1.0%	1.3%	0	-2	-10	-2	100	-2	-8	-10	21	5.3%	4.7	141	16%
Korea	0.1%	0.3%	0.6%	0.9%	1	-1	-4	-6	47	-2	-7	-4	22	4.5%	2.9	140	16%
India	0.2%	0.6%	1.6%	1.7%	-3	-10	-36	-22	118	-5	-15	-35	7	5.4%	3.5	57	6%
Indonesia	0.3%	0.9%	2.0%	0.0%	-2	-6	-21	9	92	-4	-11	-20	25	5.5%	7.0	121	14%
Macao	0.2%	0.4%	1.6%	1.3%	-6	-8	-42	4	175	-8	-13	-45	35	5.7%	2.2	22	2%
Philippines	0.3%	0.8%	1.4%	-0.2%	-2	-4	-15	8	92	-4	-10	-14	27	5.4%	6.6	56	6%
Thailand	0.2%	0.7%	1.4%	1.0%	-1	-6	-20	-2	111	-3	-12	-19	12	5.4%	4.8	20	2%
Taiwan	0.1%	0.8%	1.2%	1.0%	0	-5	-9	-4	49	-2	-11	-9	17	4.9%	6.0	16	2%
Malaysia	0.1%	0.7%	1.5%	1.1%	1	-3	-5	3	63	-1	-8	-5	19	5.2%	7.2	29	3%
Singapore	0.1%	0.3%	0.5%	0.6%	1	-1	-3	0	39	-2	-6	-3	22	4.6%	4.0	34	4%
Pakistan	0.5%	1.5%	3.7%	2.4%	-7	-32	-79	-15	364	-9	-37	-77	9	7.9%	3.6	7	1%
Sri Lanka	0.9%	3.3%	6.4%	6.5%	-11	-45	-95	-89	200	-14	-51	-95	-68	6.2%	5.9	8	1%

Source: J.P. Morgan.

Disclosures

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United Overseas Bank (UOB) - J.P. Morgan Credit Opinion History

	Date	Action	Rating/Designation	Ticker/ISIN
Issuer	16 Nov 22	Upgrade	Overweight	UOBSP

2.0% '31 c26 *	24 Feb 23	Initiate	Overweight	US91127LAE02
1.75% '31 c26	15 May 25	Downgrade	Neutral	XS2230275633
1.75% '31 c26	27 Feb 26	Terminate	Not Covered	XS2230275633
2.250% '17	08 Jun 16	Terminate	Not Covered	XS0752983154
2.5% '20	30 Mar 17	Terminate	Not Covered	XS1111112782
2.875% '17c	14 Nov 17	Terminate	Not Covered	XS0843128603
2.880% '27/'22c	25 Feb 22	Terminate	Not Covered	XS1485603408
3.500% '26/'21c	17 Sep 21	Terminate	Not Covered	XS1379133058
3.75% '19c	20 Sep 19	Terminate	Not Covered	XS1045409965
3.750% '29/'24c	19 Apr 24	Terminate	Not Covered	US91127KAC62
3.863% '32 c27	16 Nov 22	Upgrade	Overweight	US91127LAH33
3.875% perp '23c	15 Nov 23	Terminate	Not Covered	XS1699845068
5.375% '14c	29 Apr 15	Terminate	Not Covered	USY9244WAW92

Far East Horizon (3360) - J.P. Morgan Credit Opinion History

	Date	Action	Rating/Designation	Ticker/ISIN
Issuer	15 May 24	Upgrade	Overweight	FRESHK
Issuer	21 Nov 24	Downgrade	Neutral	FRESHK
5.875% '28 *	13 Sep 24	Initiate	Neutral	XS2886144232
3.375% 2025	17 Nov 23	Terminate	Not Covered	XS2109200050
4.25% '26	15 May 24	Terminate	Not Covered	XS2393797530
4.35% perp '22c	08 Sep 22	Terminate	Not Covered	XS1628787431
4.375% '23	01 Mar 23	Terminate	Not Covered	XS1781818668
4.625% '17	27 Mar 17	Terminate	Not Covered	XS1037110373
5.25% '29	27 Feb 26	Initiate	Neutral	XS3249057400
5.55% perps '17c	05 Sep 17	Terminate	Not Covered	XS1079564255
5.6% perp '22c	24 Feb 23	Terminate	Not Covered	XS1720930780
6% '28	11 Sep 25	Initiate	Neutral	XS3025777221
6.625% '27	17 Apr 24	Initiate	Overweight	XS2800583606
6.625% '27	15 May 25	Terminate	Not Covered	XS2800583606

DBS Bank - J.P. Morgan Credit Opinion History

	Date	Action	Rating/Designation	Ticker/ISIN
Issuer	06 Nov 25	Downgrade	Neutral	DBSSP
1.194% '27 *	05 Aug 22	Initiate	Neutral	US24023LAF31
1.822% 2031 / '26c	06 Nov 25	Downgrade	Neutral	XS2310058891
1.822% 2031 / '26c	27 Feb 26	Terminate	Not Covered	XS2310058891
2.246% '19	30 Mar 17	Terminate	Not Covered	US24023LAA44
2.350% '17	25 Aug 16	Terminate	Not Covered	US24023DAB01
3.3% Perp c25	21 Nov 24	Downgrade	Neutral	XS2122408854
3.3% Perp c25	21 Feb 25	Terminate	Not Covered	XS2122408854
3.600% perp '21c	17 Sep 21	Terminate	Not Covered	XS1484844656
3.625% '17c	08 Sep 17	Terminate	Not Covered	US24023DAC83
4.52% '28/'23c	17 Nov 23	Terminate	Not Covered	US24023MAA27
5.000% '14c	29 Apr 15	Terminate	Not Covered	USY2023JAR15
5.065% '31 AUD	30 Apr 26	Initiate	Underweight	AU3CB0331429

***Indicates representative/primary bond/instrument.**

The table(s) above show the recommendation changes made by J.P. Morgan Credit Research Analysts in the subject company and/or instruments over the past three years (or, if no recommendation changes were made during that period, the most recent change). Notes: Effective April 11, 2016, J.P. Morgan changed its Credit Research Ratings System. Please see the Explanation of Credit Research Ratings below for the new definitions. The previous rating system no longer should be relied upon. For the history prior to April 11, 2016, please call 1-800-447-0406 or e-mail research.disclosure.inquiries@jpmorgan.com.

Explanation of Emerging Markets Sovereign Research Ratings System and Valuation & Methodology:

Ratings System: J.P. Morgan uses the following issuer portfolio weightings for Emerging Markets Sovereign Research: Overweight (over the next three months, the recommended risk position is expected to outperform the relevant index, sector, or benchmark credit returns); Marketweight (over the next three months, the recommended risk position is expected to perform in line with the relevant index, sector, or benchmark credit returns); and Underweight (over the next three months, the recommended risk position is expected to underperform the relevant index, sector, or benchmark credit returns). NR is Not Rated. In this case, J.P. Morgan has removed the rating for this security because of either legal, regulatory or policy reasons or because of lack of a sufficient fundamental basis. The previous rating no longer should be relied upon. An NR designation is not a recommendation or a rating. NC is Not Covered. An NC designation is not a rating or a recommendation. Recommendations will be at the issuer level, and an issuer recommendation applies to all of the index-eligible bonds at the same level for the issuer. When we change the issuer-level rating, we are changing the rating for all of the issues covered, unless otherwise specified. Ratings for quasi-sovereign issuers in the EMBIG may differ from the ratings provided in EM corporate coverage.

Valuation & Methodology: For J.P. Morgan's Emerging Markets Sovereign Research, we assign a rating to each sovereign issuer (Overweight, Marketweight or Underweight) based on our view of whether the combination of the issuer's fundamentals, market technicals, and the relative value of its securities will cause it to outperform, perform in line with, or underperform the credit returns of the EMBIGD index over the next three months. Our view of an issuer's fundamentals includes our opinion of whether the issuer is becoming more or less able to service its debt obligations when they become due and payable, as well as whether its willingness to service debt obligations is increasing or decreasing.

J.P. Morgan Emerging Markets Sovereign Research Ratings Distribution, as of April 4, 2026

	Overweight (buy)	Marketweight (hold)	Underweight (sell)
Global Sovereign Research Universe*	6%	84%	10%
IB clients**	100%	86%	100%

*Please note that the percentages may not add to 100% because of rounding.

**Percentage of subject issuers within each of the "Overweight," "Marketweight" and "Underweight" categories for which J.P. Morgan has provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.

For purposes of FINRA ratings distribution rules only, our Overweight rating falls into a buy rating category; our Marketweight rating falls into a hold rating category; and our Underweight rating falls into a sell rating category. The Emerging Markets Sovereign Research Rating Distribution is at the issuer level. Issuers with an NR or an NC designation are not included in the table above. This information is current as of the end of the most recent calendar quarter.

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J.P. Morgan uses a bond-level rating system that incorporates valuations (relative value) and our fundamental view on the security. Our fundamental credit view of an issuer is based on the company's underlying credit trends, overall creditworthiness and our opinion on whether the issuer will be able to service its debt obligations when they become due and payable. We analyze, among other things, the company's cash flow capacity and trends and standard credit ratios, such as gross and net leverage, interest coverage and liquidity ratios. We also analyze profitability, capitalization and asset quality, among other variables, when assessing financials. Analysts also rate the issuer, based on the rating of the benchmark or representative security. Unless we specify a different recommendation for the company's individual securities, an issuer recommendation applies to all of the bonds at the same level of the issuer's capital structure. We may also rate certain loans and preferred securities, as applicable. This report also sets out within it the material underlying assumptions used. We use the following ratings for bonds (issues), issuers, loans, and preferred securities: Overweight (over the next three months, the recommended risk position is expected to outperform the relevant index, sector, or benchmark); Neutral (over the next three months, the recommended risk position is expected to perform in line with the relevant index, sector, or benchmark); and Underweight (over the next three months, the recommended risk position is expected to underperform the relevant index, sector, or benchmark). For CDS, we use the following rating system: Long Risk (over the next three months, the credit return on the recommended position is expected to exceed the relevant index, sector or benchmark); Neutral (over the next three months, the credit return on the recommended position is expected to match the relevant index, sector or benchmark); and Short Risk (over the next three months, the credit return on the recommended position is expected to underperform the relevant index, sector or benchmark).

J.P. Morgan Credit Research Ratings Distribution, as of April 04, 2026

	Overweight (buy)	Neutral (hold)	Underweight (sell)
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IB clients**	84%	84%	89%

*Please note that the percentages may not add to 100% because of rounding.

**Percentage of subject companies within each of the "Overweight," "Neutral" and "Underweight" categories for which J.P. Morgan has provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.

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